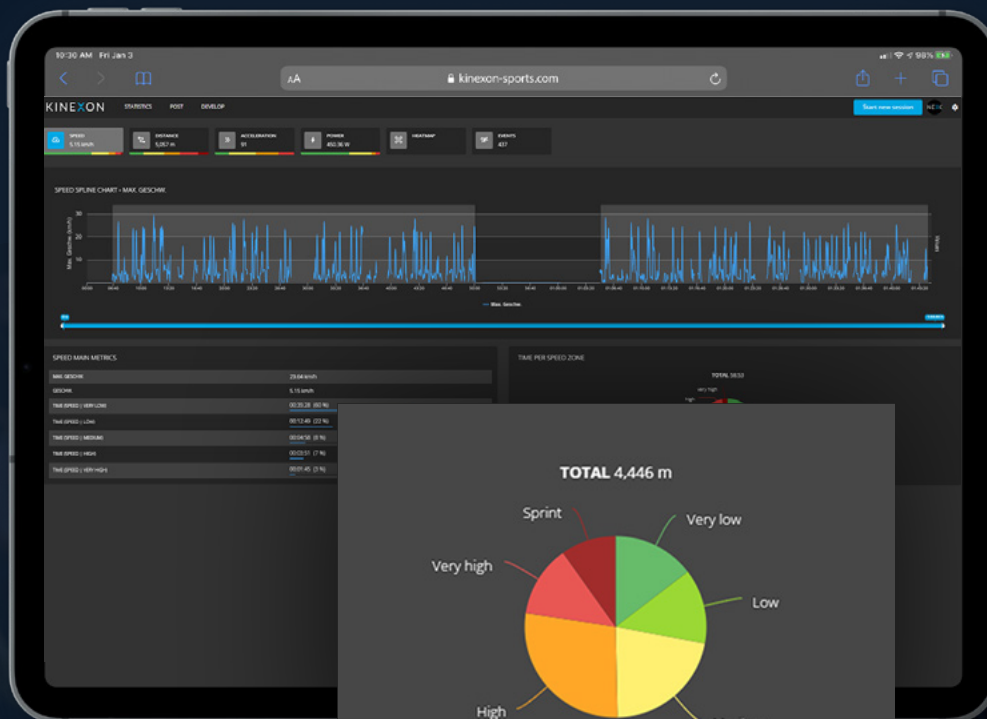
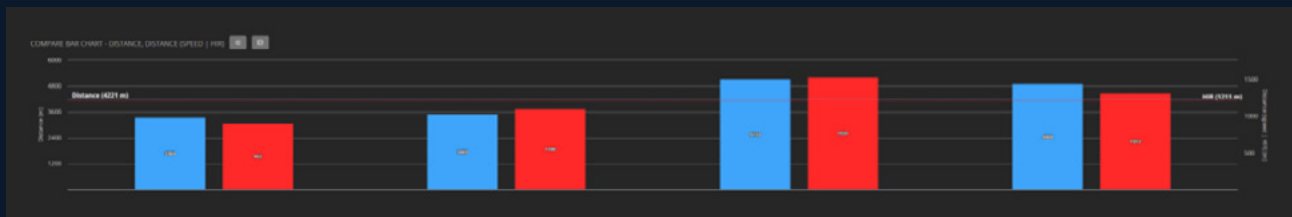


Three Player Metrics to Get Started with in Professional Handball



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If you're feeling overwhelmed about the amount of player metrics you can track, it's easier if you pick three to focus on first.



When it comes to handball, one way to get started is by tracking High-Intensity Running (HIR), Jump Load, and Accumulated Acceleration Load.

This guide will help you to understand what each metric is and how it can help you get the most out of your players.

High-Intensity Running (HIR)



Definition: HIR within this example sums up the distance within the two highest speed categories.

Importance: Handball is a dynamic sport with frequent transitions between offensive and defensive play. Players need to accelerate rapidly, sprint, and change direction. HIR reflects the ability to perform these high-intensity actions repeatedly.

Training Implications: Coaches will see a clear difference between playing positions and their demands. Based on this they can individualize the sessions more in detail.

Jump Load

Definition: It is the accumulated energy consumed by the player for all the jumps he performed during the session or phase. The energy estimate is based on the jump height for each jump.

Importance: Jumps produce a high demand on the lower limb extensor musculature, what may lead to overuse injuries such as patellar tendinopathy. Therefore, jump load is helpful to prevent injuries associated with jumps.



Measurement: Sports scientists track the number of jumps and their intensity. High jump load may indicate increased physical demand or inadequate recovery.

Practical Application: Coaches can adjust training loads based on jump data to optimize performance and prevent overuse injuries.

Accumulated Acceleration Load

Definition: It provides the accumulated load of the player/athlete during the entire session or phase. This metric adds up the differentials of accelerometer data in a single number, providing an overview of the load of the player produced by 2D-motion, jumps, impacts, etc.

Significance: Handball is a game that includes a lot of Accelerations, Decelerations, Change of Directions and reacting to the opponent. With this metric, coaches will get a good estimation of how intense the overall load of a player was during an entire session.

Practical Use: Coaches can estimate the overload of a player during a session or phase.

Start Tracking Handball Player Metrics

You can use these player metrics to help tailor training programs, optimize recovery, and enhance player performance during the long and grueling handball season.

If you'd like more information on how to manage a handball player's workload using a **player tracking system** or with the help of a **sports scientist**, **contact** KINEXON Sports at any time.